

Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

A pocket sea turtle on a keyring - the classic market impulse buy. Under half an hour, a couple of grams of yarn, and the head and flippers are worked straight into the shell so there is almost nothing to sew.

30 minutes

Easy

~3 g of yarn

FINISHED SIZE

- About 3.7 cm (1.5 in) across the flippers, 3.2 cm long and 1.9 cm deep.
- DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook; shell and underside both finish at 24 stitches.
 - A bigger 5.7 cm version is included.

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

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SAFETY FIRST

Two 4 mm safety eyes are small parts. At this size French knots are the better fit (see section 4). Not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71; for children under 3 use French knots.

The keyring is the other hazard: attach it through TWO stitches at the back of the shell and knot the yarn inside - a charm that comes off a bag is a small part with a metal ring.

MATERIALS

- Shell yarn: DK / light worsted (#3) cotton, about 1 g - sage, teal, mustard or rust.
- Body yarn: DK cotton, about 1 g in contrast cream, sand or pale green.
- Hook: 2.5 mm.
- Eyes: two 4 mm safety eyes or two black French knots.
- Also: a pinch of polyfill (under 1 g), tapestry needle, one 25 mm keyring or lobster clasp per turtle.

GAUGE

Gauge: about 3.5 mm per stitch and 3.2 mm per round. The whole charm is 203 stitches (~3 m of DK); 24 stitches = a 26.7 mm disc that sets the size.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sc single crochet

hdc half double crochet

inc increase (2 sc in one st)

dec invisible decrease

sl st slip stitch

BLO back loop only

FO fasten off

(n) stitch count at round end

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker - no joins, no chain 1 between rounds.

1. Magic ring & spiral

Start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker - no joins, no chain 1 between rounds.

2. Back loop only (BLO)

Work into the far loop only; the unused loops form a raised ridge. On the shell that ridge is the rim - it makes the dome read as a shell rather than a bun.

3. Clusters into one stitch

The trick of the head and flippers: work every stitch of the group into ONE stitch of the previous round so they share an anchor and fan into a bump. Each cluster consumes one stitch and produces as many as it contains - so a 24-stitch round produces 35.

4. Whip stitch & French knots

Join shell and underside with an even whip stitch so the seam does not pucker. Eyes: bring the needle up, wrap the floss once or twice around the needle, push back down close by and pull slowly.

INSTRUCTIONS**1. Shell - DK cotton (sage, teal, mustard or rust)**

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	BLO sc around	(24)	rim ridge
R6	sc in each st around, then FO	(24)	FO with a 30 cm tail

Before joining, embroider five or six shallow V shapes in a darker shade across the dome - two minutes, and the difference between a turtle and a green blob.

2. Underside - contrast flat disc

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	do NOT fasten off - work head & flippers next

Head & flippers (work from the live edge)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R5	3 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 2 sc	(35)	head & flippers

This consumes $3+1+4+1+3+1+4+1+3+1+2 = 24$ stitches (closing the disc) and produces 35. The first, four-stitch bump is the HEAD; the four smaller bumps are flippers. Sl st in the next stitch and FO with a 20 cm tail. The bumps land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18 and 22, placing the front flippers either side of the head.

3. Face - read before you join

The head bump is only ~7-10 mm across, and a 4 mm safety-eye washer (6-7 mm) often will not fit inside it. Use two small black FRENCH KNOTS, 2 stitches apart, low on the head bump. If you do use safety eyes, place them 1 stitch apart and seat the washers BEFORE joining - once the shell is on you cannot reach inside.

The BLO rim ridge and embroidered V markings turn the dome into a shell.

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Joining the shell (section 5): fix the eyes first. Hold the shell to the underside, wrong sides together, head pointing away from the shell's tail. Whip-stitch with the shell's 30 cm tail, matching 24 to 24 - NOT 24 to 35: the underside's outer round has 35 stitches but only 24 anchor positions (19 plain + 5 clusters). Put one shell stitch against each anchor; at a bump, pass through the BASE stitch the bump was worked into, not the bump itself.
- Add a small pinch of stuffing about three-quarters of the way round (keep it flat - the shell holds only ~8 cm³). Weave in ends. Attach the keyring through TWO stitches at the back, opposite the head, and knot inside.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Flippers uneven.**

Count the plain runs between bumps: 3, 4, 3, 4, 3, then 2 at the end.

- **Keyring pulls out / too fat to hang.**

Attach through two stitches and knot inside. Use less stuffing so the charm stays flat against a bag.

- **Shell and base won't pair.**

Count anchor positions (19 plain + 5 bumps = 24), not the 35 outer stitches.

HELPFUL TIPS

Bigger Shelby (~5.7 cm across)

Work the shell to 42 stitches: Rnd 1 (6), Rnd 2 (12), Rnd 3 (18), Rnd 4 (24), Rnd 5 [3 sc, inc] x 6 (30), Rnd 6 [4 sc, inc] x 6 (36), Rnd 7 [5 sc, inc] x 6 (42), Rnd 8 BLO sc around (42), Rnd 9 sc around (42). Work underside Rnd 1-7 the same to 42 stitches, and do not fasten off.

Underside Rnd 8 (head & flippers): 7 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st = 53 stitches, consuming all 42 anchors. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule as the small version. Allow 45-50 minutes and about 4 g of yarn.

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Safety reminder

Shelby uses 4 mm safety eyes (French knots recommended at this size) and a metal keyring. Sold as a keyring/bag charm; not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. For children under 3 use French knots, attach the ring through two stitches and knot inside.

Happy crocheting!

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